



Small Office: Five pillars of zero-trust roll-out

1. **Know your assets:** Make a two-column list – business-critical vs. replaceable. Azure, Gmail, GitHub go in column A; a dusty test VM can live in B.
2. **Segment by identity, not IP range:** HR laptops should never see CCTV streams. Use VLANs and role-based firewall rules to hard-lock that rule.
3. **Verify continuously:** Enforce MFA everywhere – no exceptions – and feed your firewall logs into a daily dashboard.
4. **Assume breach:** Log outliers matter more than averages; an office printer uploading 1 GB at 2 a.m. is an incident, not trivia.
5. **Patch within 48 Hours:** Most router CVEs now ship with public exploit code inside a week. Shrinking your patch window from “next quarter” to “two days” would have blocked more than half of last year’s SMB breaches.

Do this drill:

1. Open your firewall UI, create a “Quarantine” VLAN, and map a spare switch port to it.
 2. Move a test laptop into Quarantine, then try to hit your billing system; you should fail.
 3. Re-run after adjusting firewall rules to allow only [HTTPS](#) to a single update server.
- Congratulations – your first micro-segmentation policy works.

Create a Physical & Logical blueprint

Why two blueprints?

A physical topology shows cables, racks, and switch trunks; a logical topology shows broadcast domains, VLANs, and routing

policies. Keeping both diagrams updated is the #1 predictor of mean-time-to-repair under 20 minutes.

Step-by-step physical draft

1. **Walk the floor plan:** Take a print-out, mark structural steel, drywall, glass partitions. Wi-Fi hates metal and mirrors.
2. **Place the MDF (Main Distribution Frame):** Ideally a locked room near the ISP demarc point. If impossible, choose a corner with ceiling clearance for proper cable trays.
3. **Draw cable trunks:** Use colour-coded lines – blue for Cat 6, red for fibre uplinks. Keep each trunk under 90 metres to stay within spec.
4. **Plan Access-Point (AP) mounts:** Pencil AP icons every 12-15 metres for Wi-Fi 6; bump to 10 metres for Wi-Fi 6E on 6 GHz because range drops faster.



Logical Blueprint essentials

- **VLAN matrix:** HR, Finance, IoT, Guest, Quarantine.